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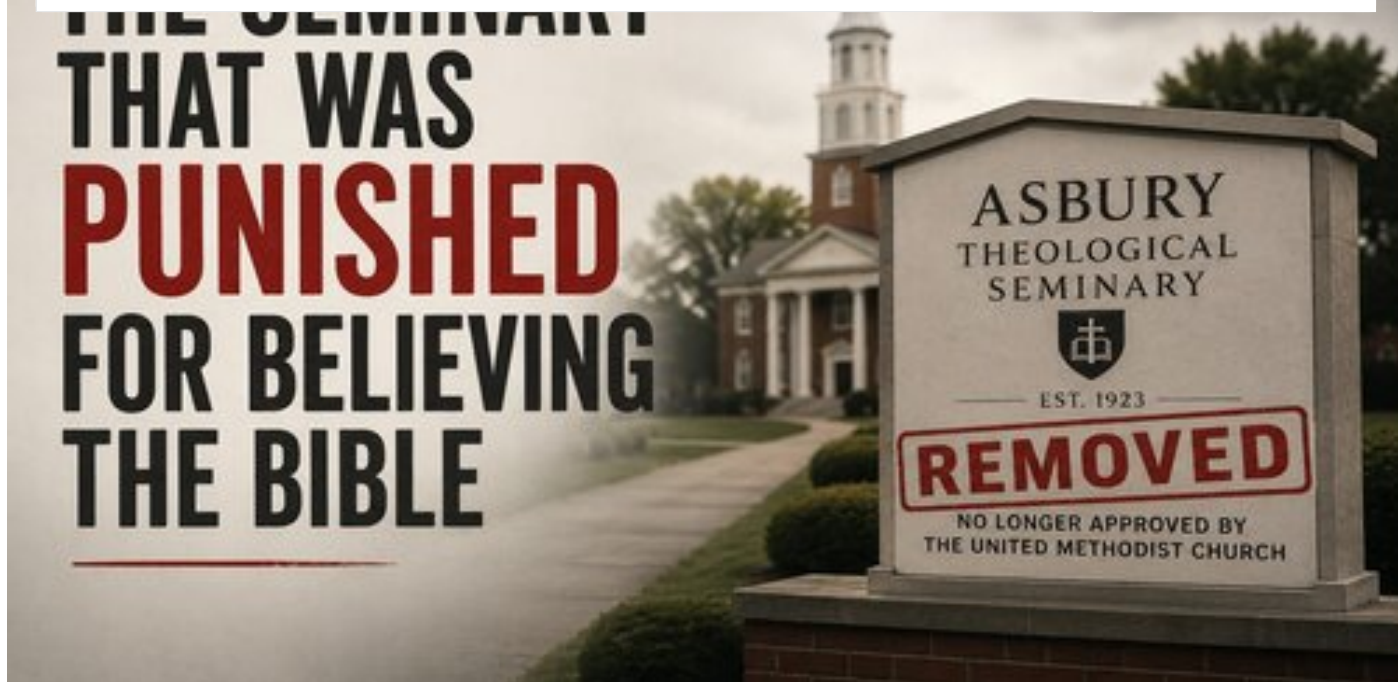
Methodists Punish Seminary For Believing The Bible



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BY PNW STAFF JUNE 29, 2026

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Imagine telling the apostles that one day a Christian seminary would be punished--not for denying Scripture, but for believing it.

Sadly, that day has arrived.

In one of the clearest signs yet of how far the United Methodist Church has drifted from its biblical foundations, Asbury Theological Seminary has been removed from the denomination's approved list of schools for ordination. Its offense was neither scandal nor doctrinal confusion. It was refusing to abandon the Bible's historic teaching that marriage is the lifelong covenant between one man and one woman.

Read that again.

A Christian denomination has officially distanced itself from one of the world's most respected evangelical seminaries because the seminary would not change what Scripture says.

That should send a chill through every Bible-believing Christian.

Asbury President David Watson made clear throughout the process that the seminary never attempted to hide its convictions. There were no backroom negotiations or carefully worded compromises. The school simply informed denominational leaders that God's design for marriage was not theirs to rewrite.

In another era, that position would have been considered basic Christianity.

Today, it is apparently grounds for exclusion.



The Wrong Side Of History

The language often heard from progressive Christianity is that those who uphold biblical morality are "on the wrong side of history."

But history tells a different story.

Every generation has faced pressure to conform God's Word to the spirit of the age. Whether the issue was Roman emperor worship, Enlightenment skepticism, theological liberalism, or today's sexual revolution, the temptation has always been the same: soften the hard teachings of Scripture to remain culturally acceptable.

The churches that chose popularity over biblical authority rarely sparked revival. They usually emptied.

The churches that endured were those willing to stand alone when necessary.

Asbury has chosen that harder path.

A Place Marked By Revival

That makes this decision even more heartbreaking.

Asbury is not some obscure Bible college hidden from public view. Founded in 1923, it has spent more than a century training pastors, missionaries, evangelists, and Christian leaders around the globe. It has earned a reputation for serious biblical scholarship while remaining deeply committed to evangelism, holiness, and the authority of Scripture.

Millions were reminded of that heritage during the remarkable revival at nearby Asbury University in February 2023.

What began as an ordinary chapel service unexpectedly continued for over two weeks as students lingered in prayer, confession, repentance, worship, and reconciliation. News crews descended on the small Kentucky campus as thousands traveled from across America--and around the world--to witness what many believed was a genuine move of God.

One reason the revival captured so much attention was what it lacked.

There were no celebrity personalities.

No political slogans.

No entertainment-driven production.



No

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How striking that only a few years later, the broader Methodist denomination is distancing itself from the theological tradition that helped cultivate such a hunger for God's Word.



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The UMC's Long Drift

This decision is not an isolated event. It is another chapter in a much larger story.

For years, the United Methodist Church has steadily moved away from historic Christian doctrine. In 2024, delegates removed language from the Book of Discipline stating that homosexual practice is incompatible with Christian teaching. They also approved same-sex weddings and opened the door for the ordination of openly LGBTQ clergy.

Those decisions triggered one of the largest denominational splits in American history, with thousands of congregations concluding they could no longer remain under the denomination's theological leadership.

Yet the movement has continued.

Many within the denomination have embraced gender ideology that conflicts with the biblical understanding that God created humanity male and female. Methodist advocacy organizations have increasingly supported expanded abortion access, moving further from historic Christian teaching on the sanctity of unborn life. Denominational agencies have also adopted increasingly one-sided criticism of Israel while often showing far less concern for the evil of terrorism directed against the Jewish state.

These are not simply political positions.

They reveal a church wrestling with a much deeper question.

Who has the final authority--God or culture?

Every compromise begins by answering that question incorrectly.

When Faithfulness Has A Price

Jesus never promised His followers that obedience would be applauded.

He promised the opposite.

Increasingly, Christians are discovering that the greatest opposition to biblical truth does not always come from secular universities, Hollywood, or government. Sometimes it comes from religious institutions that still bear Christian names while abandoning Christian convictions.

That is why Asbury's removal should not be viewed primarily as a defeat.

It is a reminder that there are still institutions willing to count the cost.

History has consistently shown that churches do not become stronger by lowering biblical standards to mirror society. They become weaker because once Scripture ceases to be the authority, every cultural trend becomes the new doctrine.

Culture changes every decade.

God's Word has stood unchanged for thousands of years.

The real question facing Christians today is no longer whether the culture will pressure the Church to compromise.

It already has.

The question is whether there will still be seminaries, pastors, churches, and believers who love the approval of Christ more than the approval of denominations.

Thankfully, Asbury has answered that question.

One can only hope more churches will do the same before faithfulness itself becomes the final disqualifier.

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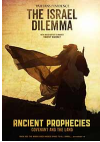


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